

Michael Johnson

Fullstack Software Engineer · Product Architect · Security-Focused Systems Builder

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

I am a highly accomplished Fullstack Software Engineer, Product Architect, and Security-Focused Systems Builder with a strong multidisciplinary background spanning enterprise IT infrastructure, cloud-native application development, UX-driven product design, and large-scale web application architecture. With a professional foundation rooted in enterprise networking and infrastructure management, I have evolved into a product-focused engineering professional capable of leading the complete lifecycle of digital product development — from conceptualisation and UX strategy through systems architecture, backend engineering, deployment infrastructure, security design, CI/CD implementation, and production release management.

I specialise in designing and engineering secure, scalable, and highly reliable web applications with a strong emphasis on trust engineering, infrastructure resilience, payment workflow systems, authentication architecture, database optimisation, and modern cloud deployment. My work combines deep technical implementation expertise with sharp product thinking, allowing me to bridge business objectives with engineering execution at pace. I have shipped multiple production-grade platforms across service marketplaces, payment protection systems, and trust-centred digital ecosystems — while also bringing enterprise-grade IT operations experience from the U.S. Department of State – OBO, American Consulate Lagos.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages

- TypeScript
- JavaScript
- Python
- SQL
- HTML5
- CSS3

Frontend

- React
- Next.js
- Tailwind CSS
- Responsive Design
- PWA
- State Management
- Component Architecture
- Accessibility

Backend

- Node.js
- REST API Design
- Serverless Architecture
- Webhooks
- Auth & Authorization
- Payment Integrations
- Background Jobs

Databases

- PostgreSQL
- Firebase Firestore
- Neon
- Aiven
- Data Modelling
- Query Optimisation
- Connection Pooling

Cloud & DevOps	- Vercel - GitHub Actions - CI/CD Pipelines	- Environment Config - Performance Monitoring - Infrastructure Reliability
Security	- Secure Auth Systems - RBAC - IAM - Payment Security	- API Protection - Fraud Prevention - Input Validation - Secure Deployment
Engineering	- Scalable System Design - Agile - Software Architecture	- Reliability Engineering - Product Thinking - Technical Documentation

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Fullstack Software Engineer & Product Architect

Aug 2023 – Present

AssetMatrix / Independent Product Engineering

Lagos, Nigeria · Remote

I serve as sole Fullstack Engineer and Product Architect, taking full ownership of the end-to-end engineering, architecture, design, deployment, security implementation, and operational management of modern web-based products. I go beyond the traditional developer scope — actively shaping product strategy, UX architecture, infrastructure planning, scalability engineering, and trust-centred systems design from first principles through to production launch.

- Architected and developed production-grade fullstack applications using Next.js, React, TypeScript, Node.js, PostgreSQL, and Firebase — with end-to-end ownership from first commit to production release.
- Engineered robust secure authentication systems incorporating session management, email verification workflows, refresh-token rotation, and multi-layer identity protection.
- Designed highly responsive mobile-first interfaces with strong focus on usability, WCAG accessibility standards, and trust-centred user experience patterns.
- Built scalable backend APIs and business logic systems supporting complex multi-party transaction workflows and marketplace operations.
- Implemented secure payment processing and escrow-inspired transaction systems using Paystack — including webhook handling, idempotency controls, fund locking, and automated payout management.
- Designed and optimised PostgreSQL schemas for serverless environments — connection pooling via Neon/Aiven, query optimisation, and efficient data access patterns.
- Developed and maintained CI/CD pipelines using GitHub Actions and Vercel — automating testing, preview deployments, and zero-downtime production releases.
- Applied full-stack security engineering: RBAC, rate limiting, input sanitisation, CSRF protection, secure HTTP headers, and infrastructure hardening.
- Translated business requirements into executable technical specifications and iteratively shipped production-ready features in close collaboration with stakeholders.

Stack: Next.js · React · TypeScript · Node.js · PostgreSQL · Firebase · Tailwind CSS · Paystack · Vercel · GitHub Actions · Neon · Aiven

Career Break · Independent Learning & Skill Development Aug 2022 – Aug 2023

IT Specialist & Networking Engineer

Jul 2021 – Aug 2022

U.S. Department of State – Overseas Buildings Operations (OBO)

American Consulate Lagos · Victoria Island, Lagos, Nigeria

I worked as an IT Specialist and Networking Engineer supporting enterprise-grade infrastructure operations within a high-security, mission-critical diplomatic environment. My responsibilities encompassed network administration, systems reliability, infrastructure maintenance, and technical support within a structured, compliance-driven operational framework.

- ≡ Configured, monitored, and maintained enterprise networking infrastructure and server systems within a mission-critical operational environment serving diplomatic functions.
- ≡ Supported enterprise-grade network connectivity, structured cabling environments, secure communications systems, and campus-wide endpoint management.
- ≡ Diagnosed and resolved complex network incidents, connectivity failures, hardware faults, and infrastructure performance issues — maintaining minimal downtime impact at all times.
- ≡ Participated in systems administration activities including patch management, OS updates, account provisioning, and Active Directory management.
- ≡ Collaborated with multidisciplinary teams to maintain secure, efficient, and compliant enterprise technology environments meeting U.S. government standards.
- ≡ Contributed to IT operational documentation, technical reporting, incident logs, and SOP development.
- ≡ Developed a deep security-first engineering mindset through exposure to U.S. government IT governance, access control frameworks, and compliance-driven infrastructure practices.

Key Areas: Enterprise Networking · Systems Administration · Network Troubleshooting · Active Directory · IT Security · Endpoint Management · IT Governance

KEY PROJECTS

TrustPoint — Secure Freelance Payment & Escrow Platform

Founder · Product Architect · Sole Fullstack Engineer

TrustPoint is a trust-centred digital payment protection and transaction management platform I conceptualised and built from the ground up to eliminate payment uncertainty between freelancers and clients. I owned the complete product lifecycle — from user research and UX architecture through systems engineering, security design, and production launch.

- ≡ Designed the full product architecture and trust-oriented UX — multi-step contract creation, fund locking, milestone-based release, and dispute management flows.
- ≡ Engineered secure escrow-inspired payment workflows via Paystack — payment link generation, fund holding, conditional approval triggers, and automated payout processing.
- ≡ Built real-time transaction tracking with webhook signature verification and a complete audit trail persisted in PostgreSQL.
- ≡ Architected Firebase Authentication with custom JWT session handling and role-based access controls between clients and freelancers.
- ≡ Deployed on Vercel with automated preview and production pipelines via GitHub Actions for zero-downtime continuous delivery.

Stack: Next.js · React · TypeScript · PostgreSQL · Paystack · Firebase Auth · Tailwind CSS · Vercel · REST APIs

Anywork365 — Service Marketplace Platform

Sole Fullstack Engineer · Product Designer · Systems Architect | AssetMatrix

Anywork365 is a scalable, trust-oriented service marketplace I engineered to connect users with skilled professionals across Nigeria and beyond. I was sole developer and technical lead — responsible for architecture, engineering, deployment, UX, and security from the ground up.

- ▮ Led end-to-end development lifecycle: wireframing, product architecture, backend engineering, deployment, and production launch.
- ▮ Designed intuitive UX flows and responsive interfaces optimised for accessibility, discoverability, and engagement across service categories.
- ▮ Architected scalable fullstack systems with Next.js, TypeScript, and PostgreSQL — covering listings, provider profiles, booking workflows, and reviews.
- ▮ Engineered cloud-native deployment on Vercel with CI/CD pipelines via GitHub Actions for continuous integration and staged production releases.
- ▮ Optimised application performance through code splitting, image optimisation, serverless cold-start mitigation, and query tuning.

Stack: Next.js · React · TypeScript · PostgreSQL · Firebase · Tailwind CSS · Vercel · GitHub Actions · REST APIs

AI & Cybersecurity Research Initiatives

Research Engineer · Ongoing

I am actively exploring intelligent systems at the intersection of identity security, fraud prevention, and ML-driven trust infrastructure — with a focus on fintech applications and emerging digital economies.

- ▮ Researching IAM architecture and zero-trust design patterns for modern web platforms.
- ▮ Exploring ML-powered fraud detection and behavioural anomaly analysis for payment systems.
- ▮ Investigating AI-driven risk scoring and intelligent verification for digital trust infrastructure.
- ▮ Studying secure fintech architecture patterns for underserved markets in emerging economies.

Focus: IAM · Zero-Trust · ML Fraud Detection · AI Risk Scoring · Fintech Security Architecture

EDUCATION

Master of Science (M.Sc.) — Information Technology

2023

University of the People

Advanced information systems · Enterprise technology management · Software engineering principles · Systems architecture · Modern computing infrastructure.

Bachelor of Science (B.Sc.) — Computer Science

2017

University of the People

Software engineering · Systems analysis · Networking · Databases · Algorithms · Programming · Distributed computing.

CORE ENGINEERING STRENGTHS

◆ Secure Web Application Development I embed security thinking into every layer of the stack — authentication, API design, deployment, and beyond.	◆ Fullstack Product Engineering I own the complete lifecycle: from concept and UX through backend systems, cloud deployment, and production launch.
◆ Scalable Architecture Design I design systems built to grow gracefully under increasing load, data complexity, and team size.	◆ Trust-Centred Product Thinking I engineer platforms that earn and sustain user trust through transparency, reliability, and intentional UX.

◆ Payment & Fintech Systems I bring hands-on depth in secure payment flows, escrow architecture, webhook handling, and financial trust infrastructure.	◆ Cloud-Native Deployment I am fluent in serverless, edge deployment, CI/CD pipelines, environment management, and infrastructure reliability.
◆ API Design & Backend Systems I build clean, well-documented, secure, and performant RESTful APIs designed for long-term maintainability.	◆ Systems Thinking & Problem Solving I bridge business complexity with pragmatic, maintainable, and future-proof engineering solutions.

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

- ≡ I am deeply passionate about engineering systems that increase digital trust, reliability, and security in emerging digital economies.
- ≡ I maintain a strong ongoing interest in cybersecurity, infrastructure engineering, intelligent fraud-prevention systems, and AI-driven identity verification.
- ≡ I continuously advance my knowledge in distributed systems design, cloud architecture patterns, secure API standards, and applied machine learning for fintech.
- ≡ I am experienced with modern Git-based workflows, feature-branch strategies, pull-request reviews, and production deployment governance.
- ≡ I am available for remote and hybrid engagements, committed to delivering high-quality, maintainable, production-grade engineering outcomes.